HERO OR TRAITOR?

Just as Snowden had predicted, attention turned to him the moment he was revealed as the person who had leaked the NSA documents. Many people labeled him a traitor and a criminal for illegally stealing secret government documents and threatening national security. Others considered him a hero, willing to risk his future to uncover government wrongdoing. Some believed he should be prosecuted to the fullest extent of the law. Others thought he should be pardoned.

Is He a Traitor?

People who called Snowden's patriotism into question ranged from intelligence officials to politicians to newscasters to corporate leaders. James Clapper, director of national intelligence, said, "This is someone who for whatever reason, has chosen to violate a sacred trust for this country. . . . It is extremely damaging to, and it affects the safety and security of this country."[1]

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Although some people viewed Snowden as a traitor, there were many other people who saw his actions as heroic and awarded him and Poitras *grants* for them.

Edward Snowden: NSA Whistle-Blower, ABDO Publishing Company, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,